

If you own a home and are at least 62 years old, you can take out a reverse mortgage on your house. Instead of making house payments, your house pays you every month! There usually is no interest, and you can use the money for whatever you want. Pay off your credit cards! Start a business! Travel the world! Contact your banker or go to www.ftc.gov.

Students

College students who qualify may be able to get a grant of up to \$4000 per year to pay their bills. Contact www.ed.gov/about/offices/list/rsa/index.html. Want to learn a foreign language? Get a fellowship grant to pay your tuition. Contact www.ed.gov/about/offices/list/oep/iegps/index.html. You can get a grant for \$28,000 to get your doctorate degree overseas and not have to repay it! Contact www.ed.gov/programs/iegps/index.html. There are hundreds of grants to help you go to school! Contact your school or state aid office or go to www.studentaid.ed.gov.

Maybe you never thought you could go to college. Even if you are no longer a 20-something, if getting a college education is your dream, it still can happen. There are programs to help you succeed. One foundation provides scholarships for lower income women who are over 35. If you have such a dream for yourself, check out www.rankinfoundation.org.

Have you finished your degree and want to continue? Many grants and fellowships are available. See http://www.aauw.org/fga/fellowships_grants/; www.grants.gov; or look up grants in your field. Opportunities abound. For example, the National Institute of Health offers programs for medical and dental students (<http://grants.nih.gov/grants/index.cfm>). You can also check out the Department of Education at <http://www.ed.gov/about/offices/list/ocfo/grants/grants.html>. There are also many private funding sources out there. One such program offers fellowships and grants for education research (http://www.spencer.org/programs/grants/research_grants.htm). Private foundations are a wonderful source for dollars that you do not have to pay back.

Tax Credits

Aside from all the free money programs out there, you also have to think about *keeping* money in your pockets. To me, this is just as